



A Studio to Edit and Roll Out Your Appliance

The Web-based SUSE Studio service makes the job of rolling out your own GNU/Linux-based distro or appliance child's play.

Typically, for a systems integrator (SI) or even a systems administrator, installing, configuring and then setting up an operating system as per the requirements is a time-consuming job, to say the least. It involves adding all the extra essential apps, deleting all that's not required, configuring other apps, etc.

What if you're an ISV? You offer customers an application but don't have an OS. You sell (support) or give away your application and whether it works or not depends on the person installing it on top of an OS on the other side of the fence. Still, you'll have to make sure that it runs properly on that OS, while sitting on this side. Or you could dictate the terms under which your application has to be used—that the customer needs to run a particular OS, for instance—which, most often, is the case anyway. The result? Some of your potential customers couldn't care less about your product.

Or, maybe you're just a regular Linux user who needs to create an OS that gives you all the applications and settings out of the box, just the way you like it. Because, configuring a default installation **your** way takes too much time. And if you need to do that every few months after a new release, it becomes quite tiresome.

What if all of you had a way to simply customise an OS with only the applications you needed and nothing extra? If, as the producer of a third party software (an ISV), you could just add your application atop the base OS, build an ISO or a virtual appliance, test it, then download and use/distribute it?

I'm sure a lot of you have probably been doing precisely this for some time—but the process isn't as straightforward as you'd want it to be. A rather wizardish approach would make things easier.

Well, I don't know what the team behind a Web service called SUSE Studio [susestudio.com] had in mind—maybe they had the same plans—but it seems this